**Stories of Science**

1. **Comic Book Collection**

**Nikola Tesla**

It was a night of storm & lighting in Croatia on July 10, 1856. When the baby boy drew his first birth. The midwife who delivered him viewed the lighting as a bad omen & declared him a “child of darkness” to which his mother firmly replied “ He will be a child of light”.

By the 1880s this boy, now a man, Nikola Tesla, was already a certified genius although with a tinge of crazy , and had won the electricity war against Edison, with his discovery of the Alternating Current. True to his mother’s words, he was always playing with current, lighting , light and energy. Many times causing accidents, burning down his labs and buildings.
It was one such experiment on his quest of wireless energy transfer that burned his lab in NY this time, that brought him all the way to the mountain top of Colorado, where he figured, air would be dry & think and hence conduct electricity better.

The town came to life at his arrival - a celebrity. But he hated the attention & did his best to elude the curious townsfolk and the intrusive reporters, leaving behind trails of mystery. But news of his various quirks spread wide & fast, about his strange requests at the hotel he was staying in -from insisting on room number that is a multiple of 3 -207 ordering 18 fresh towels to his room everyday to his germaphobic idiosyncrasies.

He got his lab built on the mountain top with a local carpenter - a lab that looked more like a barn, with a giant Tesla coil & a 142 Feet Pole with a giant copper ball on top. His experiments began, often shooting out current into the atmosphere - like Thor’s lighting bolts, lighting up the night sky of the whole town.

He didn't stop there. He was also experimenting on conducting electricity through the Earth to light up bulbs. Because Tesla injected electricity into the ground, the atmosphere around his laboratory became even more mysterious. Butterflies flitting around the laboratory seemed disoriented, and passers-by often heard sparks crackling between their shoes.
He caused several power outages in the area & had to face the wrath of the power companies that were initially letting him use electricity without cost & had to start paying for it now. He couldn't afford it & eventually abandoned the lab and the town, leaving behind tons of unpaid bills to the power company, water company & local workers, a trick he would use later towards the end of his life , staying in hotels, vanishing without making the payments.

## 2. Card Game

1. Earth Is A Sphere (T)
2. Sun Revolves Around The Earth (F)
3. Mountains Move Very Slowly (T)
4. Atoms are the smallest particles there is & cannot be split (F)
5. A Table has Energy (T)
6. Plants "exhale" Carbon-di-Oxide & Humans inhale it (F)
7. Numbers go on forever (T)
8. When we add all the numbers , both negative & positive , the result is 1 (F)
9. Plants Feel Pain (T)
10. The space around you is empty (F)
11. Rats are close cousins to humans (T)
12. Dinosaurs are extinct (F)
13. There are more microbes in our body than our own human cells (T)
14. Universe has an edge you can reach (F)
15. Octopuses have 3 hearts (T)
16. There are more people on Earth than bacteria in your mouth (F)
17. Space is continuously stretching like rubber (T)
18. Trees don't talk to each other (F)
19. Sun makes its own light (T)
20. Moon makes its own light (F)
21. Sun is a star (T)
22. Air has no weight (F)
23. Clouds are made of water (T)
24. Earth revolves around the sun, one round around the sun is 1 Month (F)

25. Earth spins on its axis & one spin is equal to one day (T)